

Customers for Products

The first approach is a

'customers for products' approach.

Here, we expect the customers to adopt to the value/features offered by the product and maybe even change their consumption style.

Making a good product or service is a monumental effort. But finding customers who have similar pains and gains requirements as offered by the product is even more difficult.

At times, despite the product being a great product, there may be no customers who are looking for the value offered by the product. Also, the effort magnifies, as often the team developing the product gets attached to it and their biases make it difficult for them to see the product-customer fit objectively.

Product - Market Fit

Firstly, design a product so great that people forget their pains and gains and adapt to the value proposition offered by the product. This is a typical case of people adapting to products rather than the product adapting to people.

Secondly, the product is designed keeping a target group in mind. The group is then studied at larger detail and a product is developed to suit their needs.

When Steve Jobs said, "*People hardly know what they want, until you show them,*" he was referring to building such a great product that people adapt their expectations to match what the product offers.

Almost all businesses around scientific innovations and discoveries bet on customers adapting to their products rather than vice versa. However, such businesses are very rare and, to understand them, the technical aspects of the product need more attention than the economic aspects of the business. Such analysis is beyond the scope of this book.